MINAR

Learn money by playing it · M2 Progress Report

Team 151

1 Current approach, and what changed since M1

Core idea is unchanged: **Minar** — a mobile-first game in a painted Hyderabad bazaar, four pillar mini-games behind the Charminar's four shops, graded on judgement rather than profit, building the same six-skill profile.

Hub rebuilt. The street-level bazaar from M1 is now a calm, high 3/4 isometric floating island (pale water, paper-grain look), pannable and zoomable, driven entirely by one content file (hotspots, path points, scenery) so art and layout can change without touching code.

- Persona flow: 3 personas (school / college / first-generation earner) plus a girl/boy avatar choice, each setting starting money, goal and difficulty.
- Progress markers: a flag per shop (locked → open → done); the Charminar gate is a solid wall until all four pillars clear, then opens into a goal screen.
- Skippable 4-beat opening story (island pull-in, persona, Nani's flower stall, fee letter) replaces the M1 street intro.
- Touch-first controls: virtual joystick plus tap/drag A* pathing, pinch/wheel zoom, portrait-rotate hint; EN/HI/TE string tables wired through i18next.

2 The four pillar games: built, pending merge to main

All four mini-games promised in M1 are now implemented and playable, each on its own branch. None are merged into main yet — main currently holds only the hub/story/movement shell; merging these branches in is the immediate next step (Section 5).

Pillar	Game	What's built
1 Plan & budget	Festival Countdown	Card-based festival-prep game: draw shop / friend / invite cards across festival days, haggle prices between shops, manage a wallet plus a savings jar, borrow when short. Engine, content tables, bot opponents, scoring; engine and string-coverage tests.
2 Save & manage	Pay Run	Week-by-week income sim: daily treat temptations (packed lunch halves food costs), random lost cash, surprise bills. Three ways to cover a shortfall — break the jar, take quick cash, or similar — each shows its true cost with none marked as the "right" one. Engine plus unit tests, including a dedicated learning-outcome test.
3 Investing	Deal Board	Most-iterated pillar: one real investment decision per quarter with judgement tracked live; four-light company signals; line-chart stock history with hover detail; tailored per-company reasoning; a trade dialog; lesson cards; a full-screen end verdict grouping choices as good / mixed / risky. EN/HI/TE.
4 Stay safe	Case Files: Mohalla Detective	Scam-detection case files with clues and a journey map; diamond/shield collectibles; exports a printable "playbook" summary. Comes with its own scripted end-to-end sweeps, a content audit, and offline / responsive checks.

3 Experiments run so far, and results

- Per the M1 test plan, Vitest unit tests are committed for the riskiest logic: Festival Countdown's pricing/haggle/borrow rules plus EN/HI/TE string coverage; Pay Run's weekly money engine plus a dedicated learning-outcome test; Deal Board's judgement/scoring; Pillar 4's case logic plus a standalone content audit test.
- Pillar 4 additionally has scripted automated play-throughs hunting for dead ends, an offline check, and a responsive-layout check.
- On the hub, the gate-unlock flow and walk-mask connectivity were verified with scripted runs against the real UI (not just by hand), after an early version left unreachable map specks.
- **Not yet run:** the cross-pillar balance pass (bots over 1,000 seeds), and the pre/post learning-question comparison — both still open from the M1 plan.

4 Progress on testing

Layer	Status
Engine	Unit tests committed per pillar (Festival Countdown, Pay Run, Deal Board, Pillar 4); not yet run together as one suite post-merge.
Balance	Not started — seeded-bot exploit sweep is still pending.
Learning	Pay Run has a first learning-outcome test; pre/post scenario questions for the other pillars are pending.
UX and access	Gate and walk-mask flows scripted and passing on the hub; Pillar 4 has its own e2e, offline and responsive scripts. A full merged-app sweep is next.
Language	EN/HI/TE wired per pillar (Deal Board added Hindi this stage); native-speaker review not done yet.
Guardrails	No-advice / no-PII banner and content audit not yet re-run post-merge.

5 Plan for the remaining time

- Merge all four pillar branches into main right away and resolve integration conflicts.

- Wire each game into its hub shop hotspot so the full loop works end to end: walk → play → consequence → flag lights → gate.
- Run the full engine test suite and the hub's scripted gate/walk/e2e checks against the merged build.
- Close the remaining gaps from the M1 test plan as time allows: the balance bot-seed sweep, learning pre/post checks for the other three pillars, and a guardrail content audit.
- Swap in new character art where it has arrived, replacing remaining placeholder sprites.
- Prepare the final submission: README run instructions, MIT LICENSE, final report, and demo video.